

Category 2 ambulance response

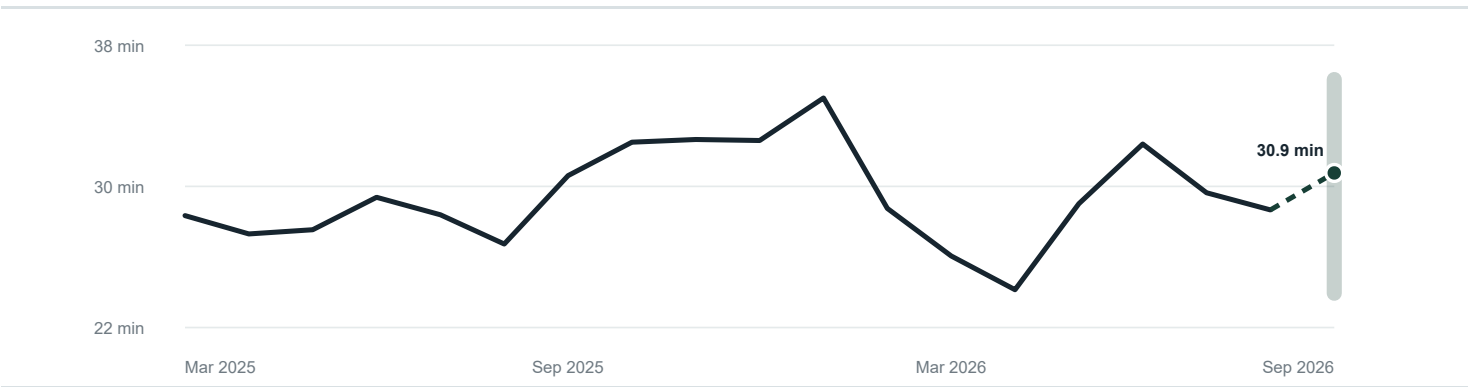
Forecast for September 2026 · data through August 2026

Category 2 ambulance response is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 28.9 min to 30.9 min. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement, partly offset by an improving underlying trend. The current projection is off course for 25 minutes during 2026/27. Sustained favourable/adverse provider signals: 0/2.

LATEST · AUGUST 2026	OUTLOOK · SEPTEMBER 2026	ACTUAL
28.9 min	30.9 min	
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 24.2 min–36.1 min	Not yet released
		Off course · 25 minutes during 2026/27

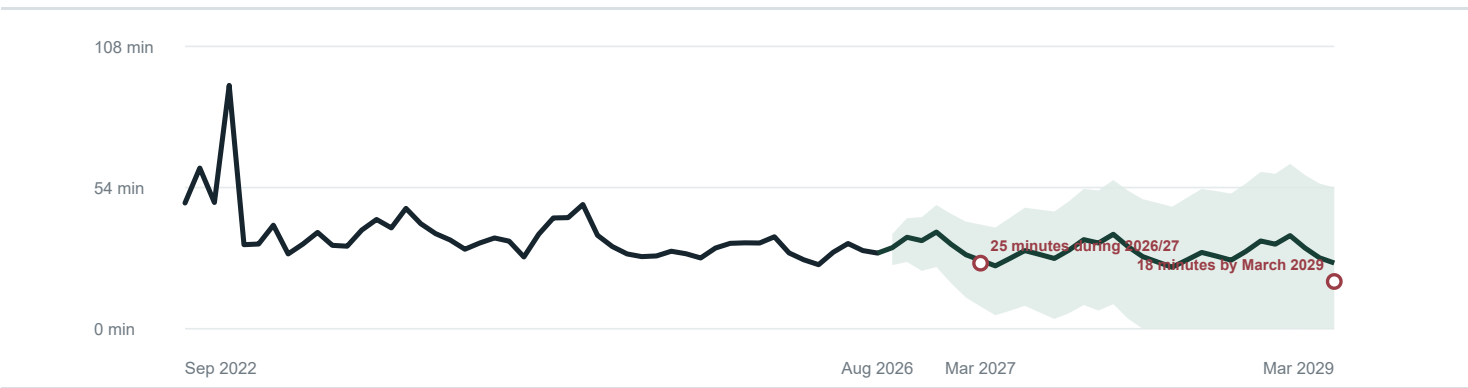
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



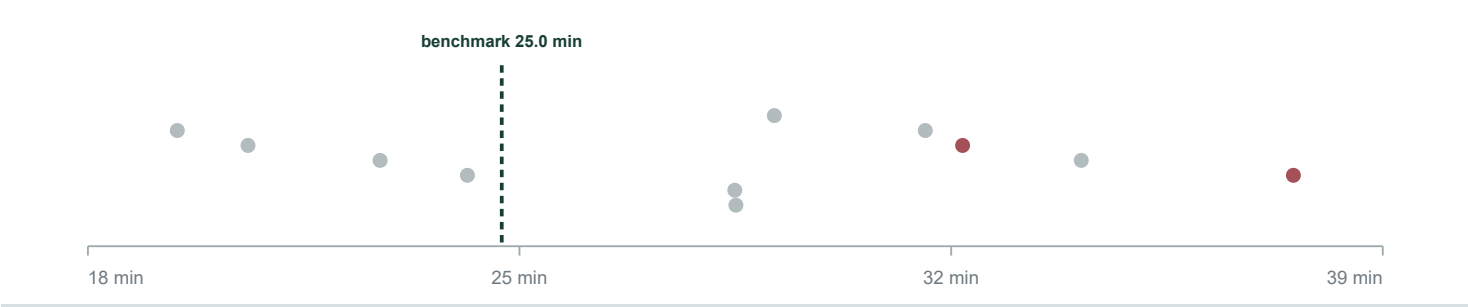
Benchmark: 18-minute standard. 1.1 min above milestone
Data: NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 109 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · August 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Sufficient national and provider history.

11

providers assessed

0

sustained favourable

2

sustained adverse

9

without an active signal

Largest sustained favourable moves

No qualifying signal.

Largest sustained adverse moves

SOUTH WESTERN AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST

Latest 37.7 min · 6 consecutive releases assessed

historically simulated

5.3 min

SIX-MONTH GAP

LONDON AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST

Latest 32.4 min · 6 consecutive releases assessed

historically simulated

3.6 min

SIX-MONTH GAP

Trajectory-watch rule. Six consecutive release surprises are compared with forecasts made before each release. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.